

Pakistan Legislative Structure

Introduction

Pakistan has a federal legislative system. Parliament forms the federal legislature. It includes the President, the National Assembly, and the Senate. Provinces have their own legislatures. Those are provincial assemblies. All assemblies operate under the Constitution.

Federal Legislature

The National Assembly is the lower house of Parliament. It holds 336 seats. General seats are filled by direct vote. There are reserved seats for women and non-Muslims. Members serve for five years, unless the Assembly is dissolved early. The National Assembly starts money bills and controls public spending. It also forms the federal government and holds it accountable. The Senate is the upper house. It has 96 members. Each of the four provinces elects 23 senators. Islamabad elects four. Senators serve for six years. Half of them renewed after every three years. The Senate cannot dissolve. Together, both houses pass bills. The President must assent to make a bill law. A joint sitting is possible if the houses disagree. The National Assembly has more authority over financial laws.

Provincial Legislatures

Each province has a unicameral assembly under Article 106 of the Constitution. Provinces elect Members of Provincial Assembly (MPAs) for five years. Each assembly has general seats and reserved seats for women and non-Muslims. Punjab has 371 seats in total. This includes general, women, and non-Muslim seats. Sindh has 168 seats, Balochistan has 65 seats, and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa has 145 seats. MPAs meet in their provincial capitals and legislate on matters under provincial domain. The assemblies check their provincial governments. They manage budgets and local laws.

Comparisons and Function

Parliament sets laws for federal matters. Provincial assemblies legislate on provincial subjects. The National Assembly starts financial legislation. The Senate protects equal provincial representation. Provincial assemblies reflect regional interests. Law-making at both levels follows constitutional procedures. The federal and provincial systems work together to balance power.

Conclusion

Pakistan's legislative system is bicameral at the federal level and unicameral at the provincial level. The National Assembly represents population, the Senate represents provinces equally. Provincial assemblies give voice to regional needs. Together, they form

a balanced federal legislative structure.

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